

30T ENGL – 2020

English – Solved

SECTION-A (Reading Skill: 10 Marks)

(a) Why do you need to think before you take printouts unnecessarily? [2]

Ans: We need to think before taking unnecessary printouts because every sheet of paper we waste means more trees being felled to manufacture that paper. Thinking for a minute reminds us of this hidden environmental cost of our daily habits.

(b) Name some of the products that can be obtained from recycled paper. [2]

Ans: Some products made from recycled/loose paper are paper bags, magazines, newspapers, cardboard egg-trays, folders, penholders, material for display boards, lampshades and teaching/learning aids.

(c) How can parents and schools help in creating awareness about paper recycling? [2]

Ans: Parents can teach their children the importance of recycled paper by bringing simple changes in their own lifestyle. Schools can train students to make paper products like folders, penholders and display materials, and encourage them to make their own cards, files and invitation cards.

(d) How can students help in saving trees indirectly? [2]

Ans: Students can save trees indirectly by exchanging their old textbooks with others in a new academic session instead of buying fresh ones, thereby saving paper and, in turn, trees.

(e) Give a synonym of 'conserve'. [1]

Ans: Preserve / save.

(f) Find a word in the passage which means 'the destruction of something, especially waste material by burning'. [1]

Ans: Incineration.

SECTION-B (Advanced Writing Skills: 25 Marks)

2. Notice about the educational trip to Delhi (50 words) [5]

RADHAKRISHNAN COLLEGE, GUWAHATI

NOTICE

Date: 3rd July 2026 This is to inform all students that our college is organizing an educational trip to Delhi during the summer vacations. Interested students must submit their names to the undersigned along with the registration fee by 10th May. Departure details will be shared soon. Gautam/Geeta General Secretary

OR: Poster on earthquake safety measures (50 words) [5]

Ans: A poster titled 'STAY SAFE, STAY ALIVE!' listing key points: Drop, Cover and Hold On during tremors; stay away from windows and heavy furniture; keep an emergency kit ready; move to open ground after shaking stops; do not use lifts; follow official instructions.

3. Report on the visit of Japanese students (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: CULTURAL EXCHANGE ASSEMBLY HELD — Our school recently welcomed a team of twenty students from Japan as part of a cultural exchange programme. A special welcome assembly was organized in their honour on the school lawns. The programme began with a traditional welcome dance performed by our students, followed by an exchange of gifts and a short cultural presentation by the visiting team about Japanese traditions. The Principal addressed both groups, emphasising friendship and global understanding. The Japanese students also interacted with our students, sharing their experiences and learning about Indian culture. The event concluded with a group photograph and refreshments, leaving both sets of students with wonderful memories of the exchange.

OR: Report on 'Say No to Plastic' campaign (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: SAY NO TO PLASTIC CAMPAIGN — The students of the local college recently organized an awareness campaign titled 'Say No to Plastic' in our town. Volunteers went door to door distributing cloth bags and pamphlets explaining the harmful effects of plastic on the environment. A rally was also taken out through the main market, with students carrying placards urging shopkeepers and residents to avoid single-use plastics. Several shopkeepers pledged to switch to jute or paper bags. The campaign received an encouraging response from residents, who appreciated the students' initiative. Such efforts are essential to protect our environment from the growing menace of plastic pollution.

4. Application for the post of Sports Teacher with bio-data [10]

Ans: A formal letter from Rekha/Ramesh of Barpeta addressed to the President, Managing Committee, Lakhimpur High School, applying for the advertised post of Sports Teacher, mentioning qualifications, sporting achievements and experience, followed by a detailed bio-data (Name, Address, Date of Birth, Educational Qualification, Experience, Achievements, References).

OR: Letter to the editor against insensitive use of loudspeakers during festivals [10]

Ans: A formal letter from Gaurav/Garima, a resident of Guwahati, to the Editor of a local daily, expressing concern over the insensitive and excessive use of loudspeakers during festivals, highlighting the disturbance caused to students, patients and elderly people, and requesting authorities to enforce noise-pollution rules strictly.

SECTION-C (Grammar: 20 Marks)

5. (a) Alexander said to Porus, "How do you desire to be treated?" He answered, "Like a king." [2]

Ans: Alexander asked Porus how he desired to be treated. Porus answered that he wished to be treated like a king.

(b) The boys exclaimed in joy that they had all passed the test and that they would celebrate their success the next day. [2]

Ans: The boys exclaimed in joy, "We have all passed the test! We will celebrate our success tomorrow."

6. Change the voice (any three) [3]

Ans: (a) The nurse is looking after this little girl. → This little girl is being looked after by the nurse. (b) Morning shows the day. → The day is shown by the morning. (f) The Governor gave him a reward. → He was given a reward by the Governor.

7. Correct tense forms (any five) [5]

Ans: (a) My brother practises law these days. (b) The patient had died before the doctor reached. (c) You were sleeping when I entered the room. (d) She will come here the day after tomorrow. (e) They won the match. (f) We visited the Taj Mahal last year.

8. Fill in with appropriate prepositions (any four) [4]

Ans: (a) The ship is sailing near the shore. (b) Cut the rope with a knife. (c) I am taller than you by two inches. (d) There was a bridge over the river.

9. Sentence transformation (any four) [4]

Ans: (a) Why waste time in this fruitless occupation? → It is useless to waste time in this fruitless occupation. (Assertive) (b) It is often difficult to speak the truth. → It is not often easy to speak the truth. (Negative) (c) Being ill, he could not attend school. → He was ill and he could not attend school. (Compound) (d) On seeing the lion, he ran away. → When he saw the lion, he ran away. (Complex)

SECTION-D (Textbooks: 45 Marks)

10.(a) 'Keeping Quiet' extract

Ans: (i) The poet wants everyone to stay still for twelve seconds/counts. (ii) He asks us to keep still and not use any language so that, for once, all human beings can share a moment of stillness free of the noisy, hectic and often destructive rush of daily life and war, and feel a sense of common humanity without the barrier of different

languages. (iii) By 'not move our arms so much' the poet means we should give up violent, aggressive and hectic activity, symbolically halting wars and industry, even if only for a moment.

OR (b) 'My Mother at Sixty-Six' extract

Ans: (i) The 'childish longing' is the poet's constant, almost desperate wish to have her mother beside her always; it is 'in vain' because her ageing mother's time is limited and this wish cannot truly be fulfilled. (ii) The poet herself waits near the open window. (iii) She prays for the sound of a stopping car, that is, for the safe return of her loved one.

11. Any three (30-40 words) [6]

Ans: (i) Through 'A Thing of Beauty' Keats conveys that beautiful things give us everlasting joy; they act as a shelter from despair, keep faith in humanity alive, and console us during life's sorrows and hardships. (ii) The young sprinting trees signify the fast pace of passing time and youthful vitality rushing ahead, contrasting sharply with the poet's ageing, frail mother. (iii) The mother is compared to the 'late winter's moon' because her pale, bloodless face looked as faint and lifeless as the fading winter moon, hinting at her nearness to death. (iv) The 'sadness' the poet refers to is that we never understand ourselves fully and constantly threaten our own survival by waging destructive wars against each other.

12. Any five (1 mark each)

Ans: (a) According to M. Hamel, the great trouble with Alsace is that people always postponed learning their own language until tomorrow, and in the end, never learnt it. (b) Mukesh wants to become a motor mechanic. (c) The original home of Saheb's family was in Dhaka, Bangladesh. (d) Gandhi was visiting Lucknow in 1916 to attend the annual session of the Indian National Congress. (e) Sophie asks Danny Casey for an autograph for Geoff. (f) Geoff works quietly at a slaughterhouse. (g) John Rowntree held a post with a British mercantile/tea firm before leaving Shillong a few days after Independence.

13. Any five (30-40 words each) [10]

Ans: (a) Wachter told Franz he would reach in plenty of time because he was teasing him, unaware of the seriousness of the notice pinned on the bulletin board about the change in language of instruction. (b) Seemapuri is a slum on the outskirts of Delhi, home to squatters, mostly from Bangladesh, who settled there in 1971 and now survive largely by ragpicking and scavenging. (c) Saheb was not happy at the tea stall; he lost the carefree independence he had as a ragpicker, and the steel canister he now carries seems heavier than his earlier plastic bag. (d) Professor Malkani's action of sheltering Gandhi was extraordinary because at that time no one dared openly support a man opposed by the British government, yet he courageously offered Gandhi refuge in his own house. (e) Besides having a boutique, Sophie also dreams of becoming a fashion designer or an actress, and of travelling widely and living a glamorous life.

14.(a) How M. Hamel makes the people realize their responsibility (80-100 words) [5]

Ans: M. Hamel gently but firmly reminds the villagers, the students and himself that they are all responsible for neglecting their own language. He recalls how parents preferred sending children to work for money instead of school, how he himself often let students water the flowers or go fishing instead of teaching, and how the villagers were never eager to learn French properly. By admitting his own share of the blame along with theirs, he makes everyone realize, on this last day, how precious their language was and how carelessly they let the chance to master it slip away, now that it is too late.

OR (b) Hazard of working in the glass bangles industry (80-100 words) [5]

Ans: The workers of Firozabad's glass bangle industry labour in dark, hot, poorly ventilated cells without air or light, often losing their eyesight before reaching adulthood due to constant work near furnaces. They handle molten glass with bare hands, risking severe burns, cuts and respiratory illnesses from glass dust. Children as young as Mukesh grow up in this hereditary occupation, trapped by poverty, moneylenders and a rigid social system that offers no alternative livelihood. Government apathy, exploitation by middlemen, and lack of organization prevent these workers from forming cooperatives that could improve their terrible working conditions.

15.(a) Similarities in the lives of Bama and Zitkala-Sa (125-150 words) [7]

Ans: Both Bama and Zitkala-Sa experienced discrimination and a painful loss of identity in their childhood. Bama, born into a Dalit family in Tamil Nadu, encountered untouchability early in life when she saw an elder of her

community carrying food respectfully by its string to avoid touching an upper-caste man; this made her aware of the humiliation her community endured daily. Similarly, Zitkala-Sa, a Native American girl, was forced into an alien boarding-school culture where her long hair, considered sacred by her people, was cut against her will, and she was made to follow unfamiliar customs like sitting on chairs and eating with strange table manners. Both narratives show children confronting oppressive systems—caste in Bama's case and colonial cultural erasure in Zitkala-Sa's—that stripped them of dignity, yet both eventually found resilience and voice through their writing, using their personal experiences to expose social injustice.

OR (b) Uruka, the important part of Magh Bihu (125-150 words) [7]

Ans: Uruka is the eve of Magh Bihu, celebrated with great enthusiasm across Assam. On this night, people, especially the youth, gather in the fields near the harvested paddy and build makeshift huts called 'Bhelaghar' using bamboo, hay and cane. They cook a community feast there, comprising rice, meat, fish and other delicacies, sharing food and stories through the night around a bonfire. An altar called 'Meji', a tall pyramid-like structure of bamboo and thatch, is built and burnt the next morning at dawn as an offering to the fire god, marking the end of the harvest season and thanking nature for a good crop. People pray for prosperity while roasting rice cakes and vegetables in the fire's embers. Uruka reflects the strong community bonding and agrarian roots of Assamese culture, bringing together people of all ages in shared festivity.

16. Any four (30-40 words each) [8]

Ans: (a) The hundredth tiger took its revenge on the Tiger King when a wooden splinter from a toy tiger, gifted to the king's son, pierced his hand during the ceremony; the wound turned septic and eventually caused the king's death. (b) The messenger came to Dr. Sadao to inform him secretly that a boat would arrive at night to take away the wounded American prisoner he was sheltering, so as to protect Sadao from danger. (c) Mr. Lamb gave Derry courage and confidence by treating him as a normal boy despite his scarred face, sharing stories about his garden and his own artificial leg, and encouraging him not to hide from the world. (d) It took Bama thirty minutes instead of ten to reach home because she stood watching, amused, as an elder of her community carried a packet of snacks by its string to avoid touching it directly, out of respect for caste customs.